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RESEARCH / OPINION

Overperforming in VCT: who's doing it?

Bobo — May 2026



Patmen at VCT Pacific Kickoff 2026, where GE went on to eventually finish 7th–8th — eliminated in the lower bracket by his former team, PRX.

Earlier in VCT Pacific Kickoff 2026, Patmen pulled off one of the craziest performances I've ever seen, dropping 32 kills and 5 deaths on Breeze. Consequently, he had a 2.81 rating, which was (and is) the highest map rating of ALL TIME. Even crazier? Global Esports lost that match 1–2. Even crazier? They lost that match to DFM (yes, the only team to end an entire VCT season without a single series win back in 2023). Even crazier? He was playing OMEN. Even crazier? He didn't bitch slap each and every one of his teammates (well, as far as we know).

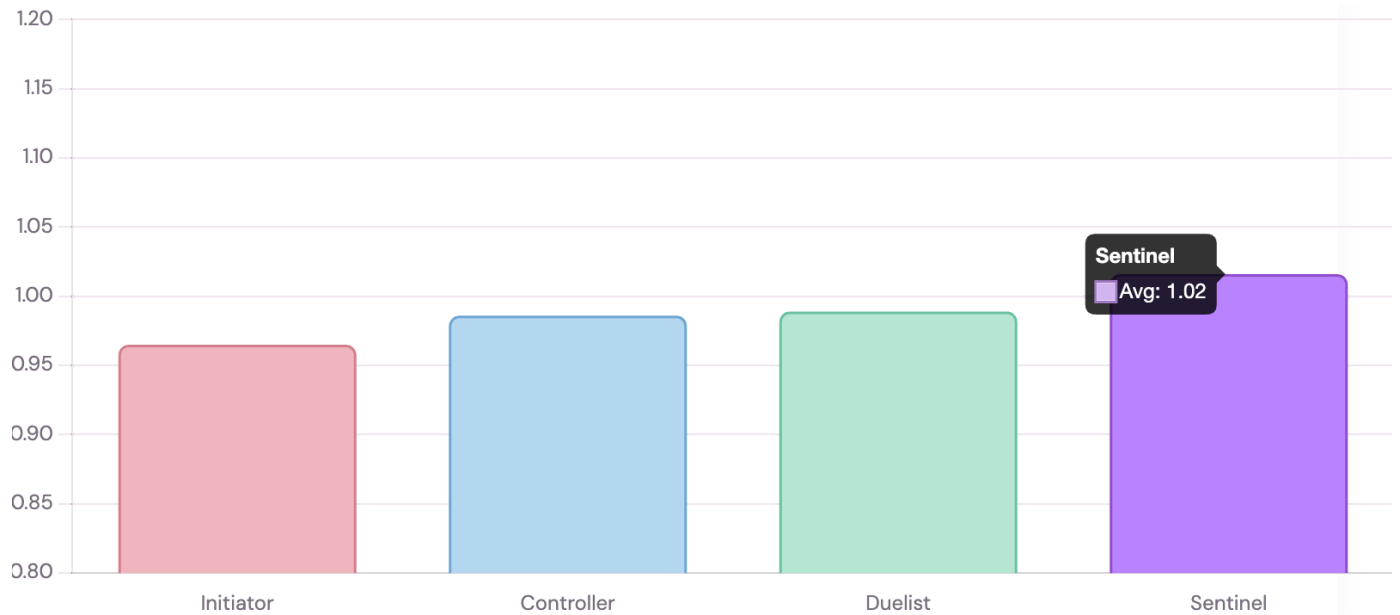
As sad as it is that Patmen is clearly better than the overall zenith of mediocrity that is Global Esports, it makes it weirder to flashback to 6 months ago, when Patmen was dropped by PRX for being the weak link in the juggernaut of a team that is Paper Rex. The two realities seem contradictory. Can Patmen really exist in this void where he's not good enough for the best but too good for the mediocre teams? However, I think this prompts a larger question of: what does it even mean to be an over/underperformer in VCT?

Tuning the Definition

Despite its detractions, the holistic approach underpinning VLR's rating system gives us as close to a good measure of player performance as we've seen. Beyond just looking at simple (but important) numbers like kills and deaths, it weights kills based on the player count and the duel's subsequent weight on the round win percentage, accounts for economic differences between teams, looks at trades/tradability, and incorporates assists. For more details, you can read more about VLR rating [here](#). At the end of the day, it emphasizes the basic yet important statistics while remaining wise to the fact that all kills and deaths are not made equal. Of course, there are still intangibles such as IGLing, midrounding, or "vibes" that have a real impact on the game, but I'm yet to see a statistic that incorporates this as well. This is all to say that VLR rating will be my response variable for this article's sake.

Next, I want to call back to a point I made in my sympathy rant for Patmen; he was playing Omen when he dropped that supercalifragilisticexpialidocious statline. For those who don't know much about Valorant or are ridiculously casual, Omen is a controller (one of the four agent classes in this game), which means that his arsenal is centered around casting smokes for his team and other strategic/movement abilities (rather than offensive ones). This is noteworthy because that would, presumably, make it harder to rack up such a high rating on a passive and selfless role. Well, let's check if this initial presumption is even true by looking at the average VLR rating by role across all regions this Kickoff 2026.

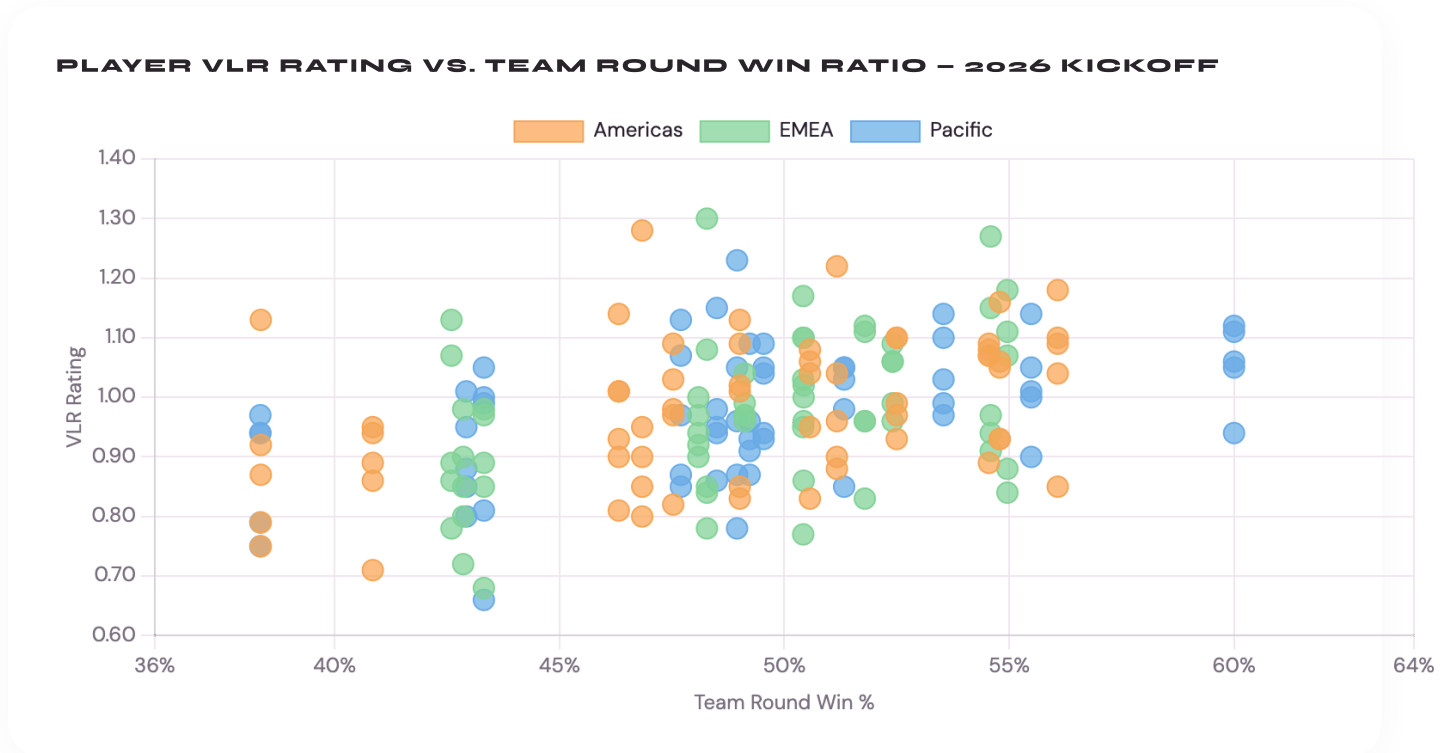
AVG. VLR RATING BY ROLE – 2026 KICKOFF (ALL REGIONS)

**AVG. VLR RATING BY ROLE - 2026 KICKOFF (BY REGION)**

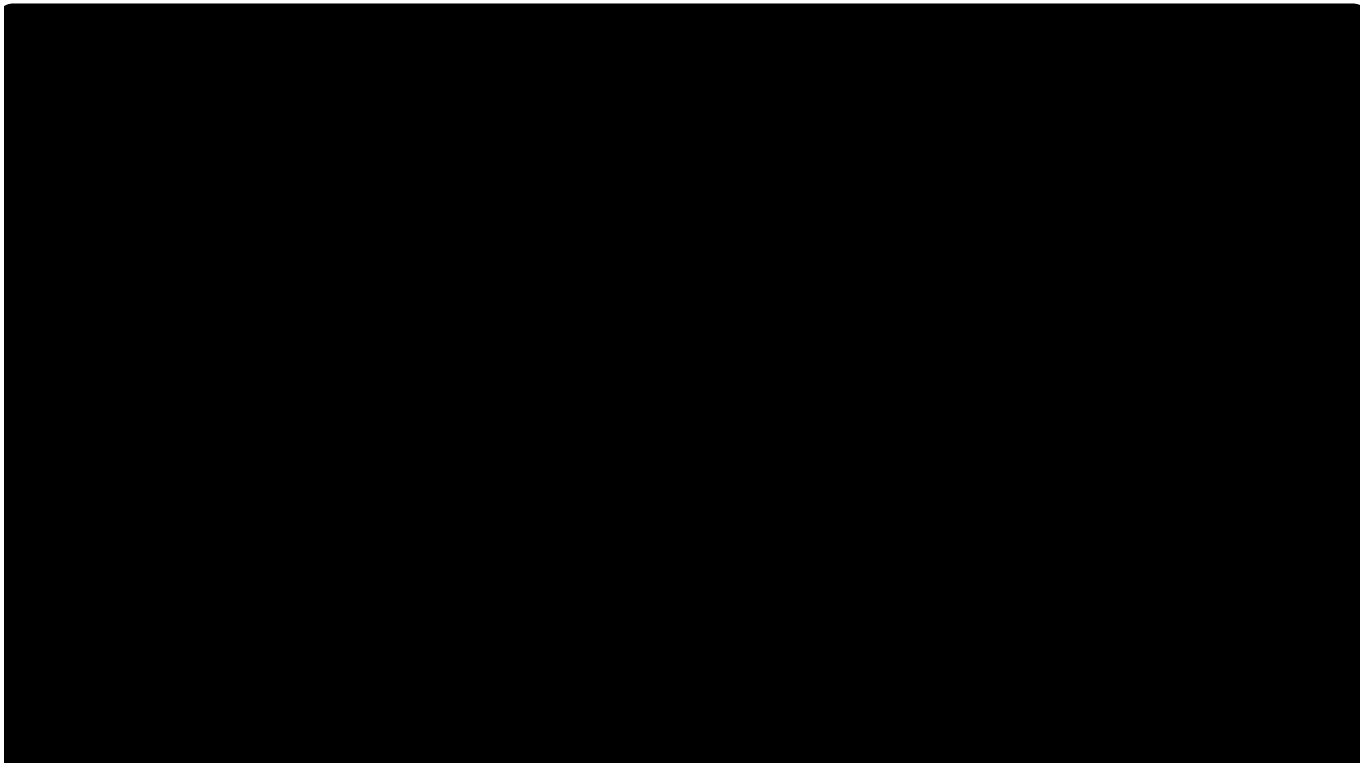
As you can see, there is a marginal, but notable difference in VLR rating by agent role. Surprisingly to me, it was the sentinel role that had the highest rating. I postulate that duelists are often dying first too frequently on site executes, controllers and initiators are forced to play with the pack, while sentinels are fully able to both lurk and bait in whatever way suits their personal performance, but I digress. The important result here is the obvious difference by role (and for those who don't know, 0.03 is a non-negligible difference between rating averages by role).

All that being said about roles, the larger point about Patmen was that his team wasn't winning at the rate you'd expect from a player posting numbers like that *irrespective of the role he was playing*. Player rating and

team success usually (and should) move together in Valorant. The theory here is that, when there's a wide gap between a player's rating and his team's win rate, it's a pretty clean signal that he's either hard carrying or getting hard carried. Let's see how this shakes out across Kickoff 2026 with a scatterplot of player VLR rating against team round win ratio.



So many fun observations to be had! First off, my initial assumption was true — there's a clear positive linear relationship between winning at a higher rate and higher VLR ratings, though any other result would be befuddling. In my opinion, it's surprising that the trend isn't even more drastic. There are a decent number of players on the winning end of teams with sub-1.0 ratings (I'm looking at you [Jawgemmo](#)), though the majority are healthily above 1. While we'll discuss this more explicitly later, you can hover your mouse over some of the notable datapoints in the top left/bottom right to see some of the biggest over/underperformers. Poor [Lukxo](#), sitting there with a 1.13 rating at the lowest end of the Round Win % axis, a higher rating than any player on NS (the highest Round Win % team). At least he got this [clip](#):

**UNRELATED SIDE NOTES ON THE SCATTERPLOT**

- The parity of EMEA compared to Americas and Pacific is visible in how the EMEA data points are more tightly spread around the 50% mark
- It's interesting to see which teams have players clustered around the same rating (e.g. PRX) and which teams have a wide range of player ratings (e.g. PCF or FNC)
- Will Primmie have a team that's close to as good as him? That clearly didn't change this Kickoff.

Mapping the Definition

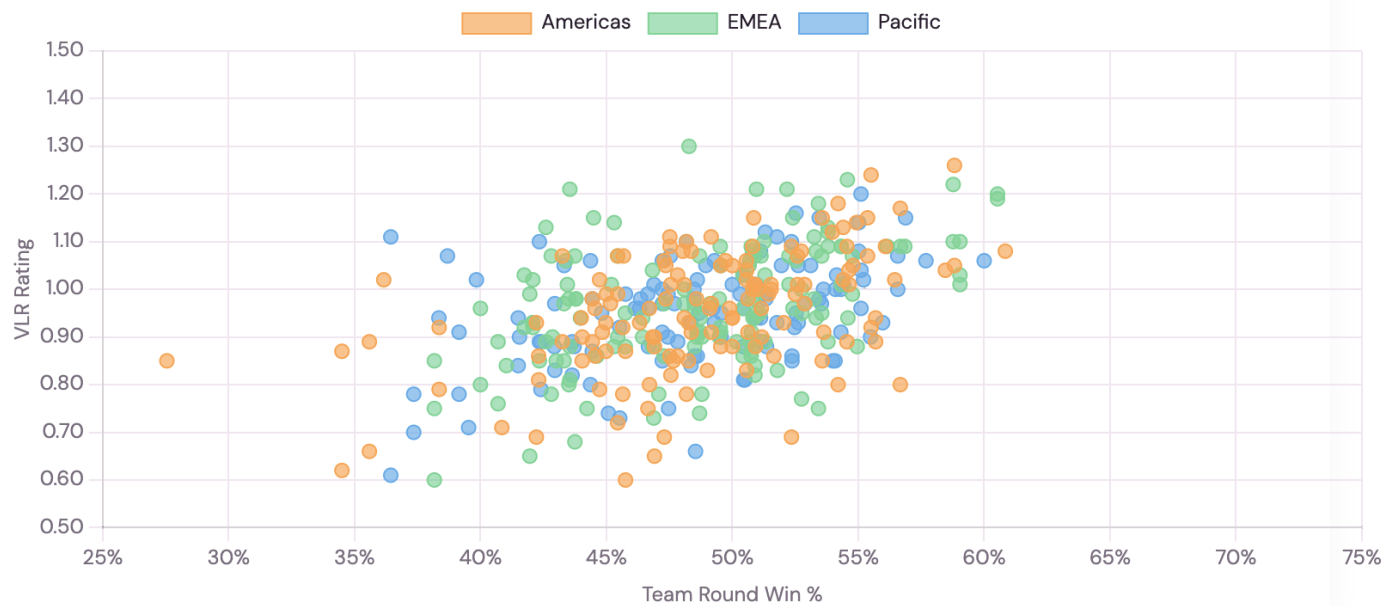
Now, what if we synthesize these two ideas: using roles and a team's round win % to observe trends in player performance? To do this, let's look at individual scatterplots, grouped by roles.

A quick clarification of the methodology:

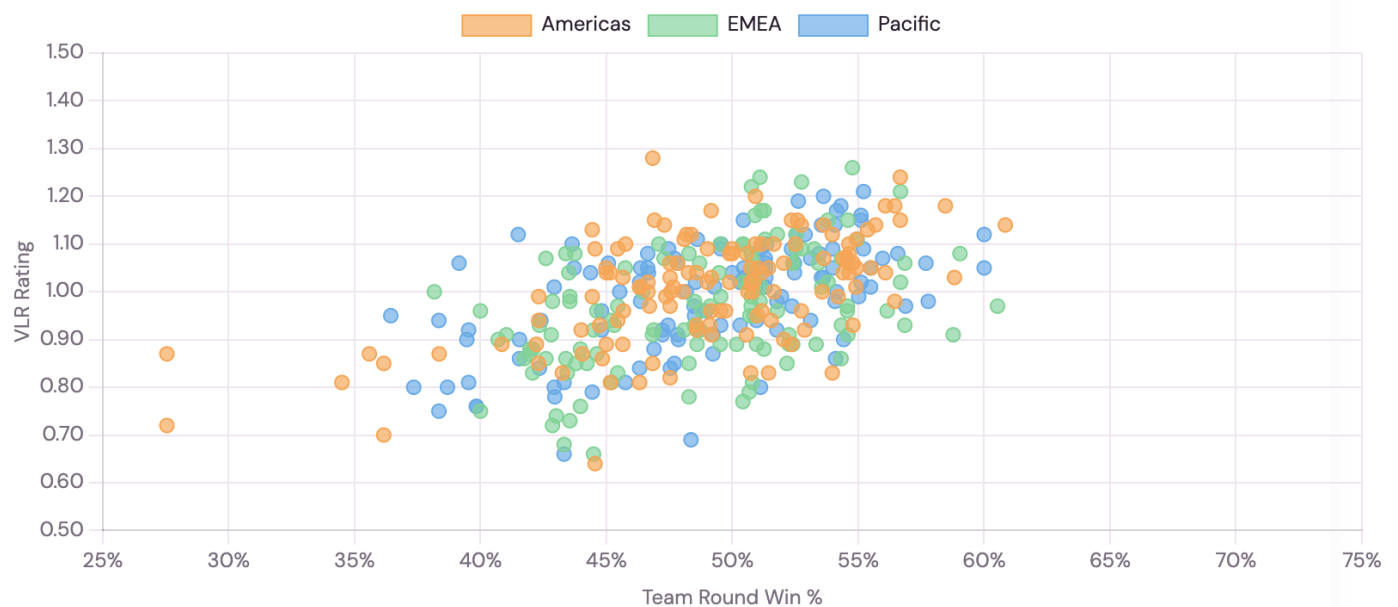
- To determine a player's "role", we look at their proportional breakdown of agent play counts in a given event and then assign them to whichever role they played on a majority ($\geq 50\%$) of their maps. In the case where there is no simple majority, as multiple roles occupy large proportions, they are classified as "Flex" and shown in a fifth chart. Additionally, as players are analyzed on a per-event basis, it's possible for a player to show up in multiple scatterplots if they switched roles.

- These graphs only use regional data, as international events introduce noise from varying competitiveness by region. Furthermore, they will skew the strongest teams' numbers downward, since making a deep run at an international means you play the best teams from every other region. Meanwhile, in regional play, every team plays through a designated schedule, so a top team's win rate is buoyed by equal-level matchups.

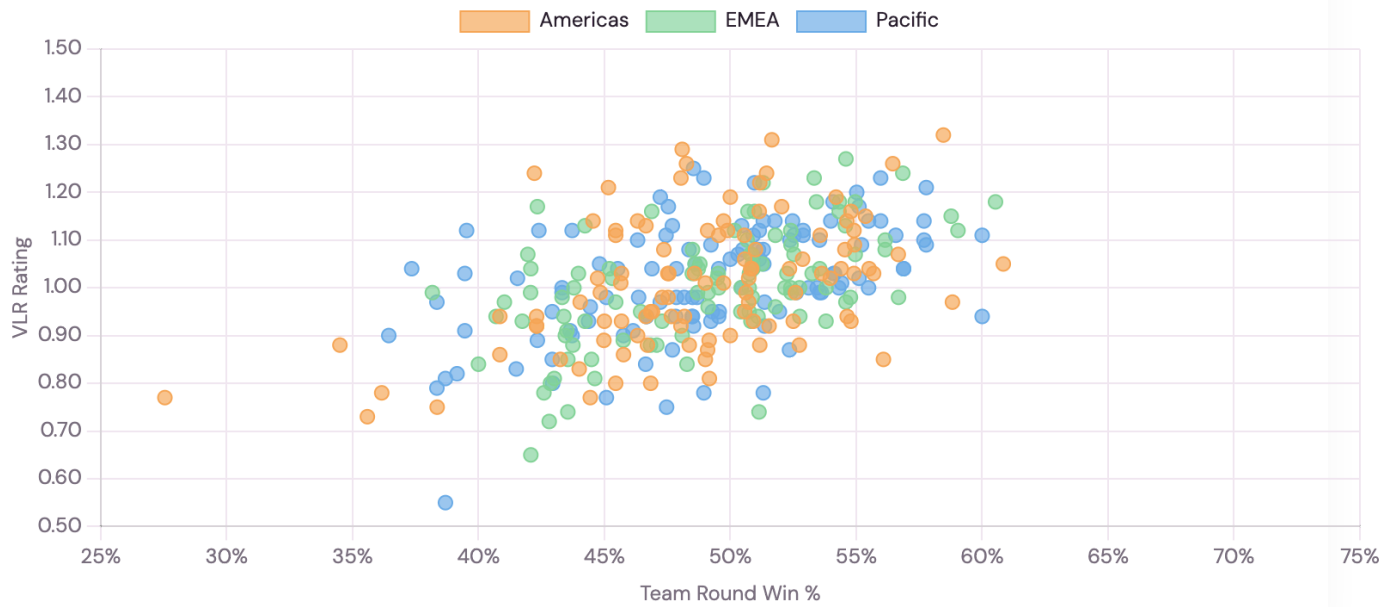
INITIATOR RATING VS. TEAM ROUND WIN % - ALL DOMESTIC EVENTS



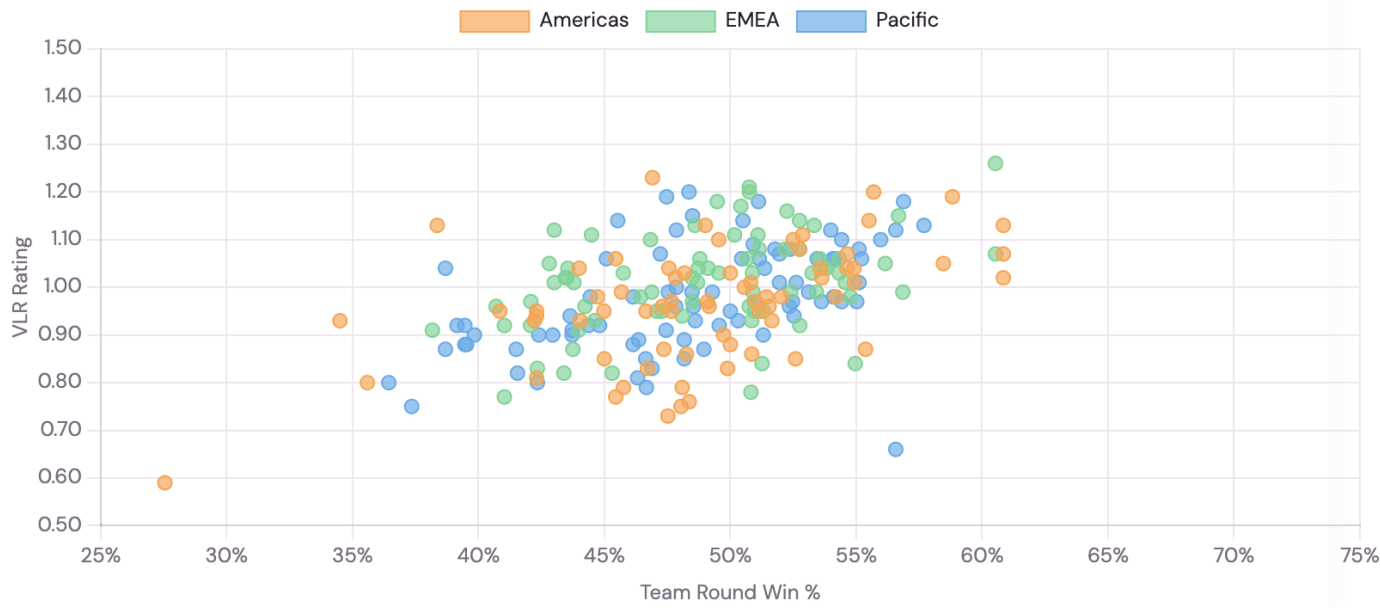
CONTROLLER RATING VS. TEAM ROUND WIN % - ALL DOMESTIC EVENTS



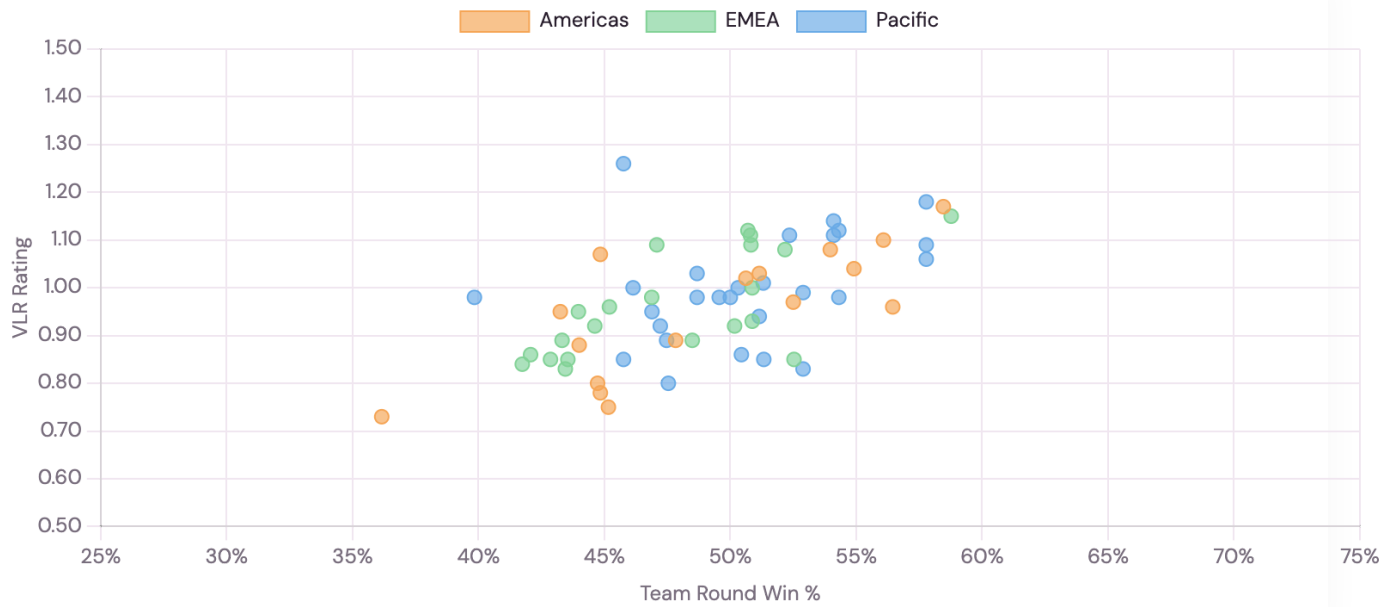
DUELIST RATING VS. TEAM ROUND WIN % – ALL DOMESTIC EVENTS



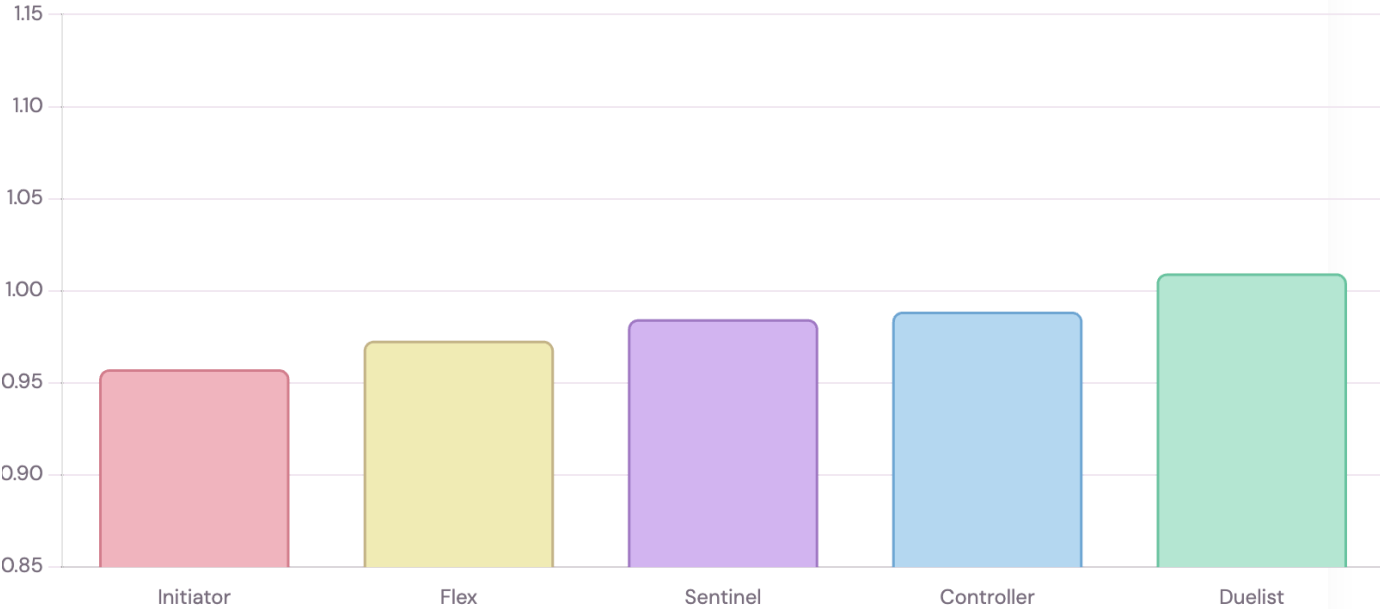
SENTINEL RATING VS. TEAM ROUND WIN % – ALL DOMESTIC EVENTS



FLEX PLAYER RATING VS. TEAM ROUND WIN % – ALL DOMESTIC EVENTS



AVG. VLR RATING BY ROLE - ALL DOMESTIC EVENTS



ROLE	AVG RATING	STD DEV	N
Initiator	0.957	0.121	403
Flex	0.973	0.115	64
Sentinel	0.985	0.112	225
Controller	0.989	0.117	374
Duelist	1.009	0.124	321

Data sourced from VLR.gg